

Word-count declaration

Manuscript: *A Reproducible Benchmark of Relational Database Access-Layer Performance in Express.js: A Configuration-Specific Comparison on PostgreSQL and MySQL* (submission build `ist/ist_main.tex`).

Counted with `texcount` on the seven body sections plus the structured abstract, with each table and figure counted as 200 words per the IST author guidelines.

Component	Count
Body text (7 sections)	12,468
Structured abstract	295
Tables and figures in the main text (9×200)	1,800
Main-text total	14,563

This is under the journal’s 15,000-word limit (and remains under it, at 14,785, even if section headers and float captions are additionally counted). The reference list (70 entries) is provided separately. Twenty-six tables and one figure are placed in the numbered online supplement (`supplement.pdf`, Supplement Tables S1–S26 and Supplement Figure S1), which is submitted with the manuscript and archived under the same Zenodo DOI as the code and data. In this revision (round 4) the manuscript was repositioned as a reproducible benchmark and a configuration-specific comparison; the body was cut to remove repeated conclusions; every per-pattern throughput table gained a 95% bootstrap confidence interval; controlled/uncontrolled-factor and per-layer-rank tables were added; and six new single-host experiments (utilization-controlled open-loop, multi-worker cluster, per-layer pool frontier on both engines, mixed read/write, replicated fan-out, and a longer-run sensitivity) were added as Supplement Tables S21–S26 with a one-sentence pointer each in the body.

Highlights (5 bullets, each ≤ 85 characters) are in `highlights.tex`.